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ANNEXES

<u>The following annexes support this OSA</u>

Publicly available annexes

Annex 040 Basic models (informative)
Annex 100 Use of colors (normative)
Annex 230 Folder structures (informative)
Annex 430 Open Core scope and licensed materials
Annex 431 Open Core scope – Level 1
Annex 432 Open Core scope – Levels 1-2
Annex 433 Open Core scope – Levels 1-3
Annex 434 Open Core scope – Full scope (levels 1-4 and levels 5-6 for class 011 OMA – Operation Manual)

Additional annexes as listed in Section 0.1.4

- Additional annexes are not part of this public release
- Annexes beyond the Open Core are managed under a structured stewardship model
- Access to such materials is not part of this public release

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0 INTRODUCTION

UHS Version 4 and UHS-OSA Version 1.0 – March 21, 2026
Status: Open Structural Architecture (OSA)
License: Open Core – free for implementation with mandatory attribution (see LICENSE)

The platform orientation and openness model is described in Section 0.1.4.

Unlike a technical specification, this OSA does not prescribe a specific technical implementation. It defines invariant structural positions, semantic roles and perspective logic that may be implemented in multiple technologies, platforms and products.

Positioning of this publication

This document constitutes the official public definition of the UHS-OSA Open Core.

It is intended to:

- enable independent understanding and implementation
- provide a stable reference for interoperability
- support global dissemination of a common structural grammar

This document does not include all materials related to UHS.

Governance, extended materials and ecosystem coordination are handled separately under a stewardship model.

This document is published as an **Open Structural Architecture (OSA)** and defines a common structural grammar for organizing operational information and tools. This document is self-contained and does not require access to additional materials for implementation of the Open Core.

In this document, the terms structural architecture, structural grammar and structural logic refer to the same invariant structural framework expressed through positional semantics and perspective models.

0.1 Background, purpose, scope and platform information

0.1.1 Background

Organizations in all sectors increasingly depend on digital information, tools and documentation to perform their operations. However, the underlying structures for organizing this material are often ad hoc, system specific or historically grown.

As a result, users face fragmented information landscapes, duplicated content and inconsistent navigation patterns. This reduces transparency, increases effort and makes it difficult to reuse information across functions, systems and organizational boundaries.

Existing standards and classification systems address specific domains, document types or processes, but do not provide a universal operational structure applicable across all types of operations.

The Universal Holistic System (UHS) addresses this gap by defining a **common structural architecture** for operational information and tools.

This OSA formalizes that architecture as a stable semantic and positional contract independent of software product, database design or interface technology.

Further background is provided in Annex 011.

0.1.2 Purpose

The primary purpose of this document is to establish **a technology-independent structural architecture** for operational information and tools that can be applied consistently in:

- conceptual models and thought structures
- documents and binders
- digital user interfaces – navigators and portals
- folder structures and networks
- document identification and classification

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By applying the same structural logic across these dimensions, organizations can reduce complexity, improve usability and enable reuse of information and tools across functions, processes and systems.

This OSA defines:

- invariant structural positions
- perspective logic
- semantic constraints
- classification rules
- the invariant relationship between them

Together these elements constitute the structural invariants of UHS-OSA and define the semantic and positional framework that implementations shall preserve. It does not define a specific software solution.

The architecture enables consistent decomposition of visions, policies, requirements and processes into operationally manageable components, while maintaining a holistic view of the operation.

Understanding and application of this OSA may be incremental. It is neither required nor expected that all concepts and annexes are applied simultaneously.

Open Core availability

This OSA defines an Open Core that is publicly available and may be implemented without restriction.

The Open Core constitutes the invariant structural grammar required for interoperability across implementations.

Additional materials, including extended classification structures, templates and governance frameworks, are not part of this public release and are managed under a separate stewardship model.

The openness of the structural core is not affected by such governance arrangements.

0.1.3 Scope

1. Scope of this document

This OSA specifies a **structural architecture** for organizing governing, supporting and describing operational information and tools.

It applies to:

1. all types of operations
2. all sectors (political, public, civil society and business)
3. all organization sizes
4. both physical and digital information environments

This OSA establishes requirements and recommendations for:

1. a common structural architecture for operational information and tools
2. classification of operational contexts and content
3. consistent use of structural perspectives across media
4. alignment between information structures and user navigation

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2. Intended users

This OSA is intended for:

1. organizations seeking a coherent structure for operational information and tools
2. public authorities and policy-makers
3. system architects and standard developers
4. auditors and certification bodies
5. developers of digital platforms, portals and AI-based tools

The target audience for platform adoption and ecosystem development is specified in Section 0.1.4.

3. Expected benefits

When implemented, this structural architecture supports:

1. improved transparency and usability of operational information
2. reduced duplication and fragmentation
3. more predictable navigation and orientation
4. interoperability across platforms and vendors
5. deterministic indexing and AI-assisted retrieval
6. long-term structural stability independent of technology shifts

0.1.4 Target audience for platform adoption

This Section complements the general intended users in Section 0.1.3 by defining actors who build products and services on top of UHS.

UHS as an operational counterpart to DDC/UDC

This OSA positions the UHS as an operational classification for organizations, analogous to how the Dewey Decimal Classification (DDC) and the Universal Decimal Classification (UDC) organize knowledge in libraries.

The intention is not to deliver a single software product, but to provide a common structural language that enables many different products, services and tools to be developed on top of the same logic.

The primary objective is rapid global dissemination of a common operational grammar rather than the maximization of proprietary revenue.

This positioning clarifies that UHS-OSA provides a structural grammar for operations in the same way that DDC/UDC provide classification for knowledge domains.

Stakeholders for platform adoption

This OSA is primarily intended for:

- entrepreneurs and IT-organizations developing operational support systems
- providers of portals, document platforms and AI-based services
- system architects seeking a common information structure
- organizations wishing to align existing systems with a common logic

This OSA defines the common grammar and structural coordinates, while each actor develops its own applications, databases and user interfaces.

Open Core and Licensed extensions

The Open Core defined in this section is fully sufficient for independent implementation and verification of the structural architecture.

The provisions in this section are normative for platform implementations.

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To balance openness and quality, UHS distinguishes between two layers:

Open layer (freely implementable)

- Operational Decimal Classification (ODC) levels 1–4
- Operation Manual (OMA) structure with 10 tabs on levels 3-6
- color and perspective logic
- principles for portals and navigators

Levels 1–4 of ODC constitute the structural semantic core required for interoperability across implementations.

For the Operation Manual (OMA), structural consistency is defined down to level 6 to ensure sufficient granularity for operational governance and navigation.

Levels beyond these thresholds may be implemented freely but are not part of the defined Open Core.

Licensable layer (optional)

- full detailed ODC structure
- certified navigators and templates
- reference implementations and mappings.

Role of the annexes

The annexes constitute integral parts of the conceptual foundation:

- **Annex 011 Background** provides the experiential and historical legitimacy (informative)
- **Annex 015 Stewardship, governance and intellectual property** safeguards semantic integrity and openness over time (normative)
- **Annex 030 Basic operational principles** describes human factors and balance pairs that motivate the structure (informative)
- **Annex 040 Basic** models explains the conceptual and geometric models that govern ODC, perspectives and structural positioning (informative)
- **Annex 100 Use of colors** defines the semantic color logic with normative provisions and an informative historical background (normative)
- **Annex 230 Folder structures** combines normative platform descriptions with informative pedagogical examples and illustrations (informative)
- **Annex 320 Portals** provides structural guidance and illustrative implementations for portal solutions based on the models defined in Annex 040 (informative)
- **Annex 330 Navigators** provides guidance for navigation mechanisms based on ODC (informative)
- **Annex 420 Classification of contexts** provides a complementary coordinate system for describing users, time, financing, geography and organizational form (informative)
- **Annex 430 Open Core scope and licensed extensions** defines the openness model and the boundary between the Open Core and licensed extensions (normative)
- **Annex 431 Open Core scope – 1 level** clarifies the first step in the description of the complete Open Core scope (normative)
- **Annex 432 Open Core scope – 2 levels** clarifies use of the four-perspective model (informative)
- **Annex 433 Open Core scope – 3 levels** clarifies the Open Core scope excluding the OMA (informative)
- **Annex 434 Open Core scope – Complete** clarifies the complete Open Core scope (normative)
- **Annex 435 Licensed materials** defines the definitive scope of materials reserved for licensed use (normative)

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0.1.5 Stewardship, governance and intellectual property

The openness described in Section 0.1.4 is combined with a stewardship model intended to protect semantic integrity and long-term interoperability.

Intellectual property principles, attribution requirements and rules for the designation “UHS Compliant” are specified in Annex 015.

Nothing in this OSA shall be interpreted as transferring ownership of the UHS concept or the protected elements listed in Annex 015.

Annex 015 is normative for all implementations claiming conformity with this OSA.

0.2 Foundational architectural principles

This OSA is based on five foundational architectural principles that define the invariant structural contract of UHS.

These principles describe the conceptual foundations of the architecture, while the structural invariants derived from them are formally realized through the Operational Decimal Classification (ODC).

These principles do not prescribe technical implementations. They define structural invariants that shall remain valid across technologies, platforms and organizational contexts.

0.2.1 Universality

The structural architecture shall be applicable to all types of operations, regardless of size, sector, maturity or geography.

Universality refers to structural applicability — not to uniform implementation.
Local adaptation is permitted, provided that invariant structural positions and perspective logic are preserved.

0.2.2 Semantic Consistency

Each structural position and class shall have a fixed and invariant semantic meaning independent of language, organizational terminology or technical platform.

Semantic consistency is the core architectural contract of UHS-OSA.
It ensures interoperability between independent implementations.

0.2.3 Cognitive Ergonomics

The structural architecture shall support intuitive human orientation.

This includes:

- consistent positional logic
- limited and invariant perspective roles
- predictable structural navigation
- simple geometric and visual models as defined in Annex 040

Cognitive ergonomics is treated as an architectural constraint, not as an interface preference.

0.2.4 Machine Interpretability

The structural architecture shall support deterministic classification, positional invariance, indexing and AI-assisted retrieval.

Each structural position shall have a fixed semantic role independent of terminology.

Machine interpretability emerges from positional invariance and limited semantic dispersion.

This positional determinism enables automated indexing, structured retrieval and reliable interpretation by AI-based systems without requiring identical terminology across implementations.

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0.2.5 Scalability

The structural architecture shall support:

- minimal implementations
- extended implementations
- incremental adoption

without breaking semantic invariants or positional logic.

Scalability refers to structural expansion without reinterpretation.

0.2.6 Architectural realization through ODC

The Operational Decimal Classification (ODC) defined in Section 4.3 constitutes the formal architectural realization of these principles.

Positions 1–4 define the deterministic semantic core of the open structural architecture and shall remain invariant across all conforming implementations.

For Open Core purposes, ODC structural invariance is defined for levels 1–4.
In the case of the Operation Manual (OMA), invariance extends to level 6 to preserve structural and navigational coherence.

0.2.7 Relation to Annex 030 and Annex 040

- The architectural principles defined in this section establish structural invariants.
- Annex 030 explains the human and cognitive motivations that justify and support the architectural choices.
- Annex 040 defines the geometric and positional models that operationalize these invariants.

0.2.8 Structural terminology (normative)

- The terms defined in this section constitute part of the architectural contract of UHS-OSA.
- Their meaning shall remain invariant across implementations and shall not be reinterpreted through local terminology, translation or platform-specific adaptations.
- These terms define structural roles, not organizational labels.

Perspective

- A logically distinct structural viewpoint within the invariant perspective models defined in Section 0.4 and Annex 040.
- A perspective defines functional meaning but not structural position.

Class

- A numbered structural category defined in the Operational Decimal Classification (ODC).
- A class is defined by its positional coordinate and its invariant semantic intent.

Category

- A logical grouping of related elements within a class or perspective.
- Categories may vary by implementation but shall not alter positional semantics.

Model

- A structured representation of perspectives, positions or relationships used to visualize or operationalize the structural logic defined in this architecture.
- Models may vary in visual form but shall preserve the underlying structural invariants.

Position

- The invariant structural coordinate of an element within a model, classification or portal structure.
- Position determines semantic role independent of terminology, organization or implementation.

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Invariant relationship

- Perspective defines functional meaning.
- Position defines structural location.
- Class defines structural grouping.
- Category defines logical grouping within structure.

These distinctions constitute structural invariants of UHS-OSA and shall be preserved in all conforming implementations.

0.3 Basic operational principles

This OSA distinguishes between:

- architectural invariants (Section 0.2)
- operational application principles (this section)

The principles below do not define structural requirements.

They explain how and why the structural architecture supports sustainable operational behavior.

The operational principles emphasize:

- **Operational needs** – structures shall support real work and decision-making, not only documentation.
- **Human factors** – fear, self-interest and inertia influence how structures are applied and must be considered in architectural design.
- **Balanced perspectives** – complementary viewpoints shall be made explicit and analyzed together rather than treated as mutually exclusive.

These operational principles explain why:

- invariant structural positions reduce ambiguity.
- limited perspective roles reduce polarization.
- balance logic supports sustainable decisions.

The structural architecture defined in this OSA is designed to create conditions where constructive operational behavior becomes more likely.

The detailed human, philosophical and experiential background is provided in Annex 030 (informative).

The operational principles described in this section are explanatory and contextual.
They do not constitute prescriptive governance models, management doctrines or behavioral mandates.
Conformance with this OSA is defined exclusively by adherence to the structural invariants described in Section 0.2 and Section 0.4.

0.4 Basic models

The models defined in this OSA constitute the structural models of UHS and provide the geometric, logical and operational foundation for organizing operational information and tools.

These structural models consist of:

- direction, position and figure models, which provide spatial and geometric structure
- perspective models, which provide logical and operational structure
- extended structural models, which operationalize and visualize the structural logic in portals
- decision models and related representations

Perspective models define the logical roles within the structure, while extended structural models operationalize these roles in concrete analytical or navigational representations.

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0.4.1 General

This OSA applies a small set of structural models that shall be used consistently to organize operational information and tools.

These models are defined and explained in Annex 040 and are based on:

- a set of **direction, positioning and figure models** that provide spatial, geometric and positional coherence
- a set of **two-, three- and four-perspective models** that provide logical and operational structure

Together these models form a unified visual and conceptual language for this OSA and UHS.

The Basic models may be expressed using spatial and graphical forms such as squares, circles, rectangles, triangles, ellipses and octagons, as described in Annex 040, provided that the underlying perspective logic is preserved.

Annex 040 is informative and provides conceptual background for the structural logic applied in this OSA.

0.4.2 Core models

1. **Two-perspective model** – for situations where two complementary perspectives must be considered together.
2. **Three-perspective model** – for simple overviews such as input–process–output or governance–execution–follow-up.
3. **Four-perspective operational model** – the primary model, structuring operations into categories such as Enablers, Processes, Results and Improvements.
4. **Five-perspective holistic model** – includes an overarching view or an additional perspective that integrates the four perspectives when a complete overview is required.

These perspective models shall be applied consistently across classifications, folder structures, user interfaces, portals, navigators and document identification.

Background and explanatory material are provided in Annex 040.

0.4.3 Extended structural models

In addition to the perspective models defined in Section 0.4.2, UHS applies a set of extended structural models that operationalize and visualize the structural logic.

These models include:

1. **Portal models** – providing structured entry points and navigation mechanisms across operational perspectives.
2. **Detailed structural implementations of portal models** are provided in Annex 320 (informative).
3. **The Temple model** – providing a visual integration of enablers, processes, results and improvements. The Temple model represents an integrated structural projection of the perspective models and shall remain structurally consistent with the perspective logic defined in this OSA.
4. **The Decision model** – providing a structured method for balanced evaluation and decision-making.
5. **The Solution philosophy model** – summarizing the conceptual principles underlying the framework.

These models do not introduce new perspectives but express and operationalize the perspective logic in different contexts.

Where these models are implemented in operational systems, their structural positions shall remain consistent with the positional semantics defined by the Operational Decimal Classification (ODC).

All platform implementations shall preserve consistency between perspective models and extended structural models.

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Annex 040 defines the conceptual and geometric foundation of the structural models, while Annex 320 defines their portal implementations.

The separation ensures that the structural logic remains invariant even when portal layouts or interface technologies vary.

0.4.4 Platform relevance

The Basic models defined in Annex 040 constitute the conceptual contract for all platform implementations including perspective models and extended structural models.

Products and services developed on top of UHS shall preserve the perspective logic of the two-, three-, four-, and five-perspective models to ensure interoperability across organizations and systems.

1 USE OF COLORS

1.1 Purpose of colors in this framework

1.1.1 General

Colors are used in this OSA and UHS as a **supporting visual aid** to improve orientation, recognition and understanding of operational structures.

Annex 100 distinguishes between normative descriptions and informative historical background.

The use of colors is intended to:

1. support predictable navigation
2. reinforce structural consistency across media
3. reduce cognitive load for users

Colors shall support the structural models defined in Section 0.4 and the semantic contract defined in Annex 100 and shall not introduce additional meaning beyond the defined structural perspectives.

Colors act as visual indicators of structural perspectives and shall not redefine structural roles established through positional semantics.

1.1.2 Platform function of colors

Colors in UHS shall function as a cross-system interface layer.

For platform implementations, colors are not decorative but constitute semantic markers that enable users and AI-services to recognize structural perspectives independent of product or vendor.

Any product or service built on top of UHS shall preserve the perspective–color mapping defined in Section 1.3.

1.2 Principle of semantic consistency

Each color used in this framework represents a **structural perspective**, not a specific function, role or organizational unit.

For ecosystem interoperability, semantic consistency of colors shall be preserved even when graphical styles differ between products as defined in Annex 100, Section 1.3.

The semantic meaning of each perspective shall be preserved across:

1. documents
2. user interfaces
3. portals and navigators
4. folder structures and visual representations

Exact color tones, shades and palettes may be adapted to organizational, technical or accessibility requirements, provided that the semantic distinction between perspectives is maintained.

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1.3 Standard structural perspectives and associated colors

The framework applies a consistent association between structural perspectives and colors as follows:

0. **Common / Holistic / External perspectives** – Blue
   Used to represent overarching views, common structures and holistic overviews.
1. **Enablers perspective** – Red
   Used to represent prerequisites, governing elements, requirements and resources.
2. **Operations / Processes / Tools perspectives** – Yellow
   Used to represent organizations, activities and supports where value is created and work is performed.
3. **Results perspective** – Green
   Used to represent outputs, outcomes and delivered value.
4. **Improvements / Internal perspectives** – Brown
   Used to represent evaluation, learning, development and improvement activities.

These associations support intuitive understanding and reinforce the four-perspective operational model and reflect the models in Annex 040.

1.4 Application of colors

Colors may be applied in:

1. headings and visual markers
2. icons and navigation elements
3. folder and file representations
4. diagrams, models and spreadsheets

Colors should not be used as the sole means of conveying information. Structural meaning shall always be possible to understand through labels, text or other visual cues.

The application of colors shall consider:

1. accessibility requirements
2. contrast and readability
3. organizational branding guidelines

Where colors cannot be applied, or where their use is restricted, the structural perspectives shall still be represented through consistent terminology, positioning and labeling.

2 FOLDERS AND FOLDER STRUCTURES

2.1 Platform relevance

This Section specifies requirements and recommendations for folder naming and folder structures used to organize operational information in common physical and digital environments.

Folder structures represent the most technology-independent implementation of UHS.

They constitute the reference model against which portals, databases and AI-services should be aligned.

Folder structures shall support:

- consistent organization of information
- predictable navigation
- efficient search and retrieval
- alignment with the Operational Decimal Classification (ODC)

When aligned with ODC, folder prefixes represent structural coordinates and therefore carry semantic meaning independent of folder naming conventions.

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Folder structures defined in this section apply equally to:

1. local file systems
2. network drives
3. cloud-based storage
4. document management systems
5. physical filing systems

Folder structures shall reflect the same structural logic as:

1. portals and navigators defined in Section 3
2. classifications defined in Section 4
3. document identification defined in Section 4.4

The same operational structure shall be recognizable regardless of medium or tool.

2.2 Naming of folders

Folders shall use number-prefixed names to ensure predictable sorting and consistent navigation.

The number prefix shall represent the structural position of the folder as defined by the Operational Decimal Classification (ODC).

Folder names shall:

1. be short and descriptive
2. avoid abbreviations that are not defined
3. use consistent language within the same structure

Colors, when applied, shall follow the semantic rules defined in Section 1.

2.3 Folder naming syntaxes

Different naming syntaxes may be used depending on the size and complexity of the operation.

2.3.1 One digit and plain text

One-digit prefixes may be used to structure small or simple information sets with up to ten main categories.

Syntax	Examples
d t where d = digit 0–9 t = descriptive text	1 Enablers 2 Processes 3 Results

2.3.2 Two digits and plain text

Two-digit prefixes may be used to subdivide larger information sets into manageable groups.

Syntax	Examples
dd t where dd = digits 00–99 t = descriptive text	10 Enablers 11 Governing documents 12 Plans 13 Operation descriptions

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2.3.3 Three digits and three letters for complex operations

For complex operations requiring detailed structuring and traceability, three-digit and three-letter prefixes shall be used.

Syntax

dddlll

where

ddd = digits 000–999

lll = defined letter code

This syntax shall be used when folder structures are aligned with ODC.

Detailed rules and examples are provided in Annex 230 and Annex 430.

2.4 Benefits of standardized folder structures

Standardized folder structures provide the following benefits:

1. **Predictable navigation** - Users recognize structure and position immediately.
2. **Efficient search** - Number-prefixed folders enable short and precise search strings.
3. **Consistency across environments** - The same structure can be applied in physical and digital environments.
4. **Reduced training needs** - Users learn one structure that applies across operations.
5. **Scalability** - Structures can grow without redesign.
6. **Improved communication** - Classification codes enable precise references (e.g. “see folder 220” which always means tools related to operational support – see Section 4.3.6).
7. **Interoperability** - Between products built on top of UHS.

3 USER INTERFACES

In this architecture, portals provide structured entry points to operational perspectives, while navigators provide structured representations of the Operational Decimal Classification.

3.1 General principles for user interfaces

User interfaces shall support **consistent navigation, efficient access to information** and **alignment with the operational structure** defined in this document.

User interfaces shall:

1. reflect the same structural logic as folders, classifications and document identification
2. provide access to all relevant operational perspectives
3. minimize the number of navigation steps required to reach information
4. support user orientation and understanding of context

User interfaces shall be designed in accordance with applicable usability and accessibility standards, such as ISO 9241 and WCAG 2.1 Level AA.

3.2 Structural alignment and orientation

User interfaces shall make the operational structure explicit and recognizable.

This includes:

1. clear indication of the current position within the structure
2. visibility of related structural levels (e.g. parent and child classes)
3. consistent use of terminology, numbering and visual cues

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The same user interface principles shall apply regardless of whether the interface is:

1. graphical
2. text-based
3. menu-driven
4. AI-assisted

Structural alignment is the primary contract between independent platform actors. Visual design may vary, but perspective, color, numbering and position logic shall remain invariant.

3.3 Portals

Portal structures shall be regarded as implementations of the extended structural models defined in Section 0.4.3.

The structural invariants of portal solutions are defined in Annex 040, while illustrative portal structures are provided in Annex 320.

3.3.1 General

Portals shall provide a coherent and holistic entry point to operational navigation to information and tools.

Portals are the primary meeting point between the open UHS core and proprietary applications.

Each portal shall:

1. be structured according to the models defined in Section 0.4
2. reflect the Operational Decimal Classification (ODC)
3. provide access to documents, tools and navigators relevant to its scope
4. preserve the structural position and semantic meaning defined by the Operational Decimal Classification (ODC) and the structural models defined in Section 0.4

Portals shall support both overview and direct access, enabling users to understand the operational context before navigating to detailed information.

3.3.2 The Operation portal

The Operation portal shall serve as the primary entry point for the operation.

It shall:

1. present a holistic overview of the operation
2. apply the three-perspective operational model
3. distinguish between common content and operation-specific content

The Operation portal shall provide direct access to:

1. The Operation Manual
2. Common:
   - information - for short onboarding
   - tools – specific tools
   - results
   - operation development projects – other projects are accessible via the additional portals
3. Additional portals as defined in Section 3.3.3.

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3.3.3 Additional portals

Additional portals may be established for specific contexts or classes, such as:

1. Operation Manual – Blue > Red > Brown
2. Processes – Red, yellow and green
3. Cases - Green
4. Projects - Green
5. Results - Green
6. The Organization - Brown
7. The Outside World - Blue

The establishment of additional portals shall not break the overall structural logic and shall maintain consistency with the Operation portal.

Examples and recommendations for portals are provided in Annex 320 which is informative and defines the structural contract for portal solutions.

3.4 Navigators

3.4.1 General requirements

Navigators shall provide structured and efficient access to information by presenting the Operational Decimal Classification (ODC) in a navigable form.

Navigators shall be regarded as the canonical representation of ODC for cross-product interoperability.

Navigators shall:

1. follow the ODC hierarchy
2. present more than one structural level simultaneously
3. shorten the path to information and tools
4. support user orientation and overview

3.4.2 Semantic compression and limited search vocabulary (normative)

Navigators shall reflect the semantic compression achieved through the limited and invariant positional vocabulary of ODC as defined in Section 4.3 and Annex 430

Unlike traditional knowledge classifications such as DDC or UDC, where the number of semantic descriptors grows rapidly across levels, UHS-ODC restricts the number of structural meanings through:

1. fixed positional semantics in levels 1–4
2. a limited and invariant set of perspective digits in position 2
3. hierarchical refinement in positions 3–9 without introducing new structural roles

This structural limitation:

1. reduces the total number of searchable semantic categories
2. improves deterministic indexing
3. enables shorter and more precise search strings
4. strengthens interoperability between platforms and AI-assisted services

Navigators shall therefore present ODC in a way that makes the positional semantics explicit and recognizable, ensuring that users and systems can rely on structural position rather than variable terminology.

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Navigators shall:

1. indicate the user's current position within the structure
2. support movement to higher and lower levels
3. allow direct access to related content across different branches where appropriate

Breadcrumb-style representations or equivalent mechanisms shall be used to show navigation paths.

3.4.3 Integration with portals and interfaces

Navigators shall be:

1. integrated into portals
2. accessible from user interfaces where structured navigation is required
3. consistent in structure, terminology and visual cues across the operation

Navigators shall reflect the same models and principles as folders and classifications.

Conceptual guidance for navigators is provided in Annex 330.

4 STRUCTURE FOR CONTEXT, OPERATIONS AND DOCUMENTS

4.1 General

This Section specifies systems for classifying and identifying information and tools related to operations. The classification systems support consistent structuring, retrieval and use of information across physical and digital environments.

Platform role of classification

The systems COC, ODC and DOF constitute the formal interface between independent implementations of UHS.

They shall function as stable structural coordinates and positional identifiers that preserve structural position and semantic meaning, in the same way that library systems rely on DDC/UDC, enabling interoperability between products, organizations and technical environments without requiring identical software solutions.

The systems include:

1. Classification of contexts, COC – optional
2. Operational decimal classification, ODC – mandatory and optional
3. Identification of documents and files, DOF – optional

Among these systems, ODC constitutes the primary structural coordinate system of the architecture, while COC and DOF provide complementary contextual and document-level identifiers.

These systems may be applied individually or in combination depending on operational needs.

Syntax: COC:ODC-DOF where ":" and "–" are dividers/interface markers

Implementations may apply to the systems individually or in combination, but when several systems are used together, the defined syntax and structural position logic shall be preserved.

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4.2 Classification of contexts, COC

Context classification enables precise identification of the circumstances under which information and tools are used. The classification system uses up to 22 positions organized in groups to capture:

- **User context** - role and purpose of use
- **Temporal context** - when information is applicable
- **Organizational context** - which entity and level
- **Operational context** - type and scale of operation
- **Geographic context** - where the operation takes place

The same operational structure shall be applied across different countries, time periods, organizational sizes, operational types and user roles.

This supports AI-based filtering, search functions and user-specific presentation of information.

COC positions map primarily to the **0 (Common / Blue)** perspective, since context is common across all operational classes.

Figure 4.2 – The three classification systems

Platform relevance

For platform interoperability, COC shall be regarded as an optional but recommended layer that enables exchange of operational information across organizations without loss of contextual meaning.

Products and services built on top of UHS should support interpretation of COC positions when such information is available.

Detailed structure and examples are provided in Annex 420.

Annex 420 contains both an OSA core proposal and an extended UHS proposal.

Implementations may support either the core variant or the extended variant and shall allow users to choose or combine them.

4.3 Operational Decimal Classification, ODC

4.3.1 ODC as Open Core of UHS

The Operational Decimal Classification (ODC) constitutes the open and common core of UHS.

The purpose of this openness is to enable global dissemination, interoperability and innovation across organizations and technical platforms.

The Operational Decimal Classification (ODC) provides a common structural grammar for operational information, comparable in purpose to the Dewey Decimal Classification used in libraries, but designed for organizations, processes and operational knowledge.

4.3.2 Quality-assured extensions

More detailed levels, certified mappings and reference implementations are provided as optional extensions to:

- safeguard semantic consistency
- support advanced interoperability
- ensure reliable interpretation in AI-assisted environments
- maintain alignment with the models in Annex 040

Governance and intellectual property aspects are specified in Annex 015.

Use of such extensions is voluntary and shall not restrict the free use of levels 1–4.

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4.3.3 Normative invariants

Any implementation claiming conformity with UHS shall preserve:

- the ten main classes 0–9, their structural positions and semantic intent
- the perspective and extended structural logic derived from Annex 040
- the positional structure of three groups with three positions
- the distinction between common content and specific content

4.3.4 Technology independence

ODC codes shall be treated as technology-independent identifiers and may be used in file systems, databases, portals, APIs and AI-services without change of meaning.

4.3.5 Positional meaning of ODC levels (normative)

General

The Operational Decimal Classification (ODC) is based on a positional decimal structure consisting of three groups with three positions (3×3).

This positional structure corresponds conceptually to the combined horizontal and vertical positioning models described in Annex 040.

Each position has a fixed and invariant semantic meaning.

Positions 1–4 constitute the minimum required invariant structure of the Open Core. For the Operation Manual (OMA), structural invariance extends to level 6 to ensure sufficient governance granularity.

The divider "." separates the three-position groups. It has no semantic meaning and functions solely as a structural delimiter.

Figure 4.3.5.1: ODC syntax with position numbers.

Positional digit 0 versus digits 1–9 (all levels)

Across all positions in ODC, digit 0 has a distinct structural role derived from the two-perspective model defined in Annex 040:

Digit 0 represents content that is common, generic or structurally reusable across operations (Blue perspective).

Digits 1–9 represent content that is specific, localized or operationally defined within a particular operation (Brown perspective).

This distinction enables:

- separation between universal grammar and local implementation,
- reuse of common content without altering structural position,
- inclusion of underlying generic structures within specific operational frameworks.

Digit 0 shall not redefine the main class or perspective role. It defines the degree of generality within the structural coordinate.

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Position 1 — Main class (0–9)

Position 1 defines the ten invariant main classes of UHS:

0 Commonly – content relevant to more than one main class, holistic, Blue

1 Overall support – governance and management, Red

2 Operative support – support for the quality of key operations – **effectiveness**, Yellow

3 Administrative support – support for productivity and sustainability - **efficiency**, Yellow

4 Key operations/processes – creation of customer value, Green

5 Cases – handling of individual matters, decisions and case-based work, Green

6 Projects – temporary assignments with defined start, end and objectives, Green

7 Results – outputs, assessments, performance and customer value/products, Green

8 The Organization – structure, roles, competencies and internal conditions, Brown

9 The Outside World – external stakeholders, legislation, markets and societal factors, Blue

The semantic intent and structural position of these ten classes shall remain invariant and shall not be reinterpreted by implementations.

Position 2 – Structural role (1–4)

The digits in Position 2 applies the Three and Four-perspective operational models defined in Section 0.4.2 and Annex 040:

Digits	1	2	3	4
Class 0	Enablers	Tools	Results	Improvements
Class 1-4	Enablers	Processes – Tools & Activities	Results	Improvements
Class 5	Incoming cases	Ongoing cases	Pending/Closed cases	Archived cases
Class 6	Enablers	Ongoing projects	Project assessments	Archived projects
Class 7	Assessments	Products	Reports	
Class 8	Management & staff functions	Support functions	Production functions	Other functions
Class 9	Controlling stakeholders & factors	Cooperating stakeholders	Controlled stakeholders	Knowledge sources
Class 1-4	1 Overall support	2 Operational support	3 Administrative support	4 Key operations/processes

Figure 4.3.5.2 – Position 2 colors

Position 2 expresses the operational function of content within its class, independent of organizational terminology.

The colors associated with Position 2 provide a visual expression of the operational perspective represented by the positional digit.
They function as semantic orientation cues that reinforce the invariant positional meaning defined by ODC.
Colors therefore support rapid human recognition and machine interpretation of structural roles without altering the positional semantics of the classification.

The limited and invariant set of meanings in Position 2 significantly reduces semantic dispersion and enables:

- predictable classification,
- efficient search and sorting,
- deterministic indexing,
- AI-assisted interpretation.

Positions 3–9 – Hierarchical subject refinement

Positions 3–9 refine the subject defined by Positions 1–2.

These positions:

- do not introduce new perspectives,
- do not redefine structural role,
- increase granularity through hierarchical decomposition.

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Compared with knowledge classifications such as DDC or UDC, ODC structurally limits semantic proliferation by maintaining invariant perspective logic and fixed positional semantics.

This controlled expansion:

- limits the number of searchable structural categories,
- improves interoperability,
- preserves machine interpretability.

The structural limits of the Open Core are defined in Annexes 431–433.

Normative requirement

Implementations claiming conformity with this OSA shall:

- preserve positional semantics of positions 1–4,
- preserve the structural distinction between digit 0 and digits 1–9,
- apply the appropriate perspective model in Position 2,
- not reinterpret positional meaning,
- use the divider solely as a structural delimiter.

For Class 011 (Operation Manual), all nine positions shall be preserved to maintain structural traceability.

4.3.6 Example

011.110.2 – Mission:
0 COMMONLY > 01 Enablers > 011 Operation Manual > 011.1 Enablers > 011.11 Governing documents > 011.110 Common - Overall > 011.110.2 Mission

220.511 – Technical procurement templates:
2 OPERATIONAL SUPPORT > 22 Tools > 220 Common for all operations > 220.5 Procurement & Logistics > 220.51 Requisitioner > 220.511 Inquiry templates

220.6 – Quality tools:
2 OPERATIONAL SUPPORT > 22 Tools > 220 Common for all operations > 220.6 Quality Assurance

330.113 – Presentation of assessments related to HR:
3 ADMINISTRATIVE SUPPORT > 33 Results > 330 Common for all operations > 330.1 HR > 330.11 Assessments > 330.113 Presentations

411.1 – Enablers for the core operation/process:
4 KEY OPERATIONS/PROCESSES > 41 Enablers > 411 Operation specific > 411.1 Core operation/-process

901.1 – Dewey Decimal Classification, DDC:
9 THE OUTSIDE WORLD > 90 Commonly > 901 General Search with Decimal Classification Systems > 901.1 Dewey Decimal Classification

ODC codes shall be regarded as technology-independent identifiers and may be used in file systems, databases, portals, APIs and AI-services without change of semantic meaning.

The list of classes is provided in Annex 430.

4.4 Identification of documents and files, DOF

4.4.1 Platform relevance

DOF shall be used as a lightweight interoperability mechanism between products and repositories, independent of file format, storage location or technical platform.

When DOF is combined with ODC, the resulting identifier shall provide unambiguous reference to both structural position and individual document.

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4.4.2 Syntax

ddd where ddd=document number which can be designed as follows:

General

Running numbers 001-999

Categories

ddd=Category **d** with running numbers dd=01-99

ddd=Category **dd** with running numbers d=1-9

Collection of information

000=Main document

d00=Annex X related to Section d in the Main document 000

dd0=Sub-annex Y related to Section d in Annex X to the Main document 000

4.4.3 Examples

011.110.1-000 – Constitution (on country level)

011.110.1-000 – Statues/Bylaws (below country level)

011.110.2-000 – Country laws - Main document (on country level)

011.110.2-000 – Mission statement - Main document for Mission (below country level)

011.110.2-600 – Marketing strategy, Annex 6 to Main document for Mission (below country level)

011.110.2-006 – The Children and Parents Code (1949:381) (Part 6 of Swedish Law)

220.511-100 – Scope & Specification for inquiry

220.6-015 – Quality Assurance document no.15

Implementations may extend DOF with local metadata, provided that the core syntax remains unchanged.

4.4.4 Functional document identifiers (optional)

Certain DOF codes may be reserved to identify functional document types that serve structural roles within UHS-OSA.

These identifiers do not affect the positional meaning defined by ODC. They provide a practical and recognizable mechanism for identifying key document functions across implementations.

These identifiers may be used in file names, repositories or document management systems to enable consistent recognition of document roles.

When used, such identifiers shall:

- not override ODC positional semantics,
- not introduce alternative classification logic,
- remain subordinate to the structural coordinates defined by ODC.

The use of functional DOF identifiers is optional and serves primarily practical and administrative purposes.

4.4.5 Examples

000=Content description and metadata (meta tags)

001=Navigator

002=Portal

003=Document register

Implementations may extend DOF with local metadata, provided that the core syntax remains unchanged.

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